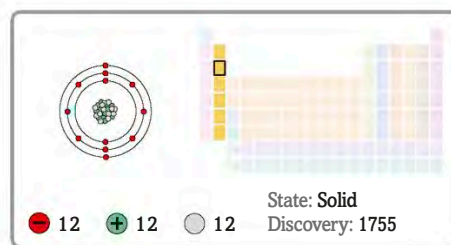


12
Mg

Magnesium



Forms

This green, magnesium-rich mineral forms deep underground.



Serpentine



Feather-like appearance

Tremolite

Shiny, grey crystallized form



Laboratory sample of pure magnesium

Magnesium has
22 known isotopes.



Dolomite

This ore is a natural form of magnesium carbonate.

Magnesium was named after Magnesia in Greece. This element largely exists deep inside Earth's mantle, but it can also be found in seawater and many minerals in our planet's crust, including **serpentine**. Another mineral, **dolomite**, is also a source of **pure magnesium**.

Magnesium has many important applications. Alloys of magnesium are not only strong, but also lightweight, so are used in a range of objects, from **car wheels** to **cameras**. For centuries, many naturally occurring magnesium minerals have been used in traditional medicines.